

Consumer Engagement Readiness Checklist

A pre-flight check before you commission a single session.

Genuine engagement is mostly decided before it starts, in the choices you make about timing, people, and follow-through. Run through this before you commission anything. If you cannot tick an item honestly, that is where the work is.

Purpose and timing

- ☐ The decision this engagement will inform is named, and is still open.
- ☐ People are being brought in while the brief can still change.
- ☐ We can say plainly what their input can and cannot influence.

People

- ☐ We have asked who is most affected, not only who is easiest to reach.
- ☐ We know who is missing, and what it would take to include them.
- ☐ No single person is being asked to represent an entire community.

Method

- ☐ The method was chosen to fit the question, not habit or convenience.
- ☐ People can take part in a way that suits them, not only us.
- ☐ We have planned how raw input becomes themes we can act on.

Respect and remuneration

- ☐ Consumers are paid fairly for their time and expertise.
- ☐ Access needs, travel, and support have been budgeted for.

Governance and follow-through

- ☐ Someone owns the decision about what happens with what we hear.
- ☐ We have committed to reporting back, including where we did not act.
- ☐ There is a way to carry the lessons into the next project.